

Redemption



A standing man places the price into open hands. Someone kneels, no longer clutching what he owed. Freedom here has a receipt.

Before you gather

- Read Day 17, Redemption, in The Visual Gospel. Do not reteach the essay.
- Read 1 Peter 1:18–19 and Mark 10:45 in your Bible. The excerpt below is only a backup.
- Your people should already have answered the day's reflection questions. Do not ask those again.

- Leave with a name. The missional challenge only works if someone is named before you pray.

1 • ICEBREAKER • 7 MIN

Open the room

What have you been glad to be done with because somebody else finished paying?

Leader. A debt ended because someone paid. Then open 1 Peter 1. We were ransomed with the blood of Christ. Say that passing is allowed, especially the first few weeks.

2 • THE WORD • 8 MIN

See it, then say it

IF YOU NEED THE WORDS

Say: Redemption means Jesus paid with His blood to free us from slavery to sin. We were bought. We are not our own.

DEFINITION, FROM THE BOOK

Redemption is God's gracious act of purchasing and freeing His people from slavery to sin, death, and judgment through the payment of Christ's blood, securing their release and restoration to Him.

IN THE ORIGINAL LANGUAGE

Greek *apolytrōsis* — a release secured by the payment of a ransom.

MEMORY VERSE • EPHESIANS 1:7

In him we have redemption through his blood, the forgiveness of our trespasses, according to the riches of his grace.

Together, open the flashcard for Redemption. Say the word, the definition, and the verse once. Then put the phone away.

3 • OPEN THE BIBLE • 15 MIN

1 Peter 1:18–19 and Mark 10:45

Ephesians 1:7 is the memory verse. Stay in 1 Peter 1:18–19 and Mark 10:45. The price is blood, not silver.

You were ransomed from the futile ways inherited from your forefathers, not with perishable things such as silver or gold, but with the precious blood of Christ, like that of a lamb without blemish or spot. For even the Son of Man came not to be served but to serve, and to give his life as a ransom for many.

Have two readers if you can. Bibles open. The excerpt is only here so a forgotten Bible does not stop the night.

From the passage

1. 1 Peter 1:18–19 says you were ransomed from the futile ways of your fathers. With what? Not with what? **CORE**

Leader. Not with silver or gold. With the precious blood of Christ, a lamb without blemish. The old life was futile. The price was blood.

2. Mark 10:45: the Son of Man came to serve and to give His life as a ransom for many. Why did He come?

Leader. He came to die. Service and ransom belong together. He did not come only to inspire us.

4 · AROUND THE ROOM · 20 MIN

A conversation this chapter did not assign

3. 1 Corinthians 6:19–20 says you are not your own, for you were bought with a price. What does a bought person stop doing?

Leader. They stop living as if their body and their week belong to them. Glorify God. Be concrete, not vague.

4. If a friend thinks they are free because they answer to nobody, how does redemption tell the truth? **CORE**

Leader. Freedom from God is slavery to sin. Real freedom is being bought by Christ. Say that with kindness, and say it.

5. Who near you is stuck under a real burden? What can you loosen this week, and what sentence about the blood will you add?

Leader. A ride, a bill, an afternoon. Then: Jesus paid with His blood to free sinners. Your help is not the ransom.

5 • SAY IT • 5 MIN

In one sentence

Redemption means Jesus paid with His blood to free us from slavery to sin and bring us to God.

Ask for two volunteers, not the whole circle. They may look at the sentence, then try it without looking. Clumsy and true is the goal.

6 • THIS WEEK • 5 MIN

Missional challenge

Before next week, carry this word to someone far from Jesus — a neighbor, a classmate, a coworker, a friend. Do it with a real action and with a true sentence. Name the person before you pray.

Loosen one real bind for someone far from Jesus — a bill, a ride, an afternoon. Tell them Jesus paid with His blood to free sinners. Your help is not the ransom.

Leader. Do not promise a miracle you cannot keep. Name a freedom that is real and small, and name the blood. Next week, before the icebreaker, take one minute. Who went, and what happened? One sentence. No speeches.

7 • PRAY • 8 MIN

Pray these, and leave room for others

1. Lord Jesus, You gave Your life as a ransom. We praise You.
2. Forgive us for living as if we were not bought.
3. Free the one we will name, and give us words about Your blood.

Before you stumble

Do not turn redemption into God paying Satan a fee, as if the devil set the price. The price is the blood God required, and Christ paid it. Also do not say people are redeemed who will not have Christ. Call them to trust Him.

WITH STUDENTS

Ask what they would do if someone else paid a debt they could not pay. Then read Mark 10:45. He came to give His life.

IF YOU STILL HAVE TIME

Titus 2:14. He gave Himself to redeem us and to purify a people. Read it. Redemption leads to holiness, not to doing whatever we want.